

Write it out

One technique to learn a spelling is to look at the word, cover it up, write it out from memory, then check it. Do this as many times as necessary until the word is right.

LOOK

tongue

COVER

tong

WRITE

tongue

CHECK

tongue

tongue

What's the problem?

Another way to learn an irregular spelling is to investigate what makes it so difficult. Look at the word and underline the part that is strange or hard to remember. Highlighting the problem will make it easier to recall.

leopard

The *o* is silent.

restaurant

The *aur* sounds like it should be spelled *er*.

twelfth

It's strange that this word uses an *f* and *th* to make the final sound.

Speak differently

If a word isn't written how it sounds, say it out loud, pronouncing it so that it does match the spelling.

definITely

Try stressing *it* to remember that it isn't spelled *at*.

WED NES DAY

Say this word in its separate parts to make it easier to spell.

particularLY

Start to stress the *arly* to remember that it isn't spelled *erly*.

Words within words

Another trick is to look for smaller words in longer ones. This will associate the longer word with the smaller word. Visualizing these small words with pictures will make spelling the longer word much easier.

Draw images like this to visualize the words within words.

There is a rat in separate



Silly sayings

Making up ridiculous phrases can help people to remember spellings. These are called mnemonic devices. One method is to think of a phrase whose words begin with each letter in the tricky word. Other sayings can remind people of the number of particular letters in a word.

RHYTHM

Rhythm Helps Your Two Hips Move

Each word in the saying starts with a letter from the spelling.

BECAUSE

Big Elephants Can't Always Use Small Exits

This saying reminds people that the word has one *c* and two *s*'s.

NECESSARY

One coffee with two sugars